watching the saddest part of Cuban socialism's last chapter – living proof of the island's own nihilistic version of a Generation X without any dreams of a future beyond the next purchase."[38]

The derogatory term *jinetera* [prostitute] and, by association, *jinetero*, came to refer to anybody who received some kind of benefit from association with foreigners. It could be the licensed taxi driver or the professional who moonlighted without a license; it could be the unofficial tour guide who found foreigners a room or a meal. But the term carried with it a weight of illegitimacy. Even if the activity was perfectly legal, calling it *jineterismo* implied that it was selling oneself for the almighty dollar. Some Cubans opined that the country itself was selling out its ideals for dollars.

But the line between *jineterismo* and the free market is a murky one. After all, performing services or providing goods in exchange for pay is inherent in the capitalist system. What looked like *jineterismo* in Cuba could be called simply the law of supply and demand in a capitalist country. Even academics, in the capitalist world, are quite accustomed to designing research projects based on where grant money exists, while publishing houses select manuscripts based on some kind of judgment of what will sell.

Opting to Leave: The 1994 Exodus

The United States greeted Cuba's economic crisis with a surge of publications predicting "Castro's Final Hour." Meanwhile President Clinton tightened the embargo in 1992 with the Torricelli legislation.

In the summer of 1994 the economic crisis was at its worst. The full effects of the Special Period hung oppressively over the country. Food was scarce. As the burning summer wore on, electricity cuts stilled the fans that most Cubans relied on. Meanwhile most of the population looked on as the lucky few who had access to dollars, and the newly opened dollar stores, exhibited their purchases. In August, something snapped.